

doc-adoption

Affirms · Soteriology › Adoption · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

By adoption, those justified are received into the family of God, granted the privileges, name, and inheritance of sons through union with Christ and indwelling of the Spirit of adoption.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical demonstration that believers, by faith in Christ, are placed into the legal-relational standing of sons of God. The technical term is υιοθεσία *huiothesia* G5206 (literally 'son-placing'), the Greco-Roman legal term for adoption attested in classical Greek (Pindar, Herodotus) and used by Paul five times: Rom 8:15 (πνεῦμα υιοθεσίας *pneuma huiothesias*, 'spirit of adoption' by which we cry ἄββᾶ ὁ πατήρ *abba ho patēr*, G5/G3962), Rom 8:23 (waiting for τὴν υιοθεσίαν *tēn huiothesian*, the future bodily redemption), Rom 9:4 (Israel's old-covenant ἡ υιοθεσία *hē huiothesia*), Gal 4:5 (ἵνα τὴν υιοθεσίαν ἀπολάβωμεν *hina tēn huiothesian apolabōmen*, 'that we might receive the adoption'), Eph 1:5 (προορίσας ἡμᾶς εἰς υιοθεσίαν *proorisas hēmas eis huiothesian*, 'having predestined us for adoption'). The lexical force is unmistakably the legal-status placement of an outsider into the rights of a son. Rom 8:14-17 layers the technical term with witnesses: those led by the Spirit are υἱοὶ θεοῦ *huioi theou* G5207 ('sons of God'); the Spirit cries *Abba*; the Spirit συμμαρτυρεῖ *symmarturei* G4828 ('bears witness with') our spirit that we are τέκνα θεοῦ *tekna theou* G5043 ('children of God'); and we are κληρονόμοι *klēronomoi* G2818 ('heirs') of God and συγκληρονόμοι *sygklēronomoi* G4789 ('joint-heirs') with Christ. Gal 3:26 (πάντες υἱοὶ θεοῦ ἐστε διὰ τῆς πίστεως *pantes huioi theou este dia tēs pisteōs*, 'you are all sons of God through faith') and Gal 4:4-7 set sonship and Spirit-indwelling and inheritance together: God sent the Son to redeem those under law that we might receive adoption; because we are sons God sent the Spirit of his Son into our hearts crying *Abba*; therefore not slave but son and heir through God. John 1:12-13 uses the parallel τέκνα θεοῦ frame: to those who received him, who believed in his name, he gave ἐξουσίαν *exousian* G1849 ('right, authority') to become children of God, born not of blood, nor of the will of flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God (ἐγεννήθησαν *egennēthēsan* G1080). 1 John 3:1-2 anchors the relationship in the Father's love: see what love the Father has given that we should be called τέκνα θεοῦ, and so we are; what we shall be ἐσόμεθα *esometha* is not yet revealed, but when he appears we shall be ὅμοιοι *homoioi* G3664 ('like') him. Eph 1:5 grounds the adoption in the Father's eternal εὐδοκίαν τοῦ θελήματος *eudokian tou thelēmatos* ('good pleasure of his will'). The doctrine is pan-canonical at the lexical level, anchored in the technical legal term *huiothesia*, expanded by the parallel *teknon-theou* frame in Johannine literature, with both present-spiritual reality (Rom 8:15, Gal 4:6) and future-bodily consummation (Rom 8:23, 1 John 3:2). Universally affirmed across all tracked Christian lineages; the only disagreement is on the prominence of adoption in the *ordo salutis* and whether it is a distinct benefit alongside justification (Reformed) or folded into baptismal regeneration (Catholic) or expressed primarily through theosis (Eastern Orthodox).

Reasoning

Verdict: by trusting in Jesus, the believer is placed into a new legal and family standing as a son or daughter of God, with the full rights, relationship, and inheritance that go with being God's child. This is not a metaphor only; the apostles use the specific Greek word for legal adoption used in Greco-Roman law. The strongest reason from Scripture is Romans 8 verses 14 through 17. Those who are led by the Spirit of God are sons of God. You did not receive a spirit of slavery to fall back into fear, but you received the Spirit of adoption, by whom we cry, *Abba*, Father. The Spirit himself bears witness with our spirit that we are children of God; and if children, then heirs, heirs of God and fellow heirs with Christ. Three distinct witnesses are laid down in those verses: the leading of the Spirit, the cry of *Abba* in the believer's heart,

and the inward testimony of the Spirit alongside the believer's own spirit. Galatians 4 verses 4 through 7 says the same thing from the other side. When the fullness of time had come, God sent his Son, born of woman, born under the law, to redeem those who were under the law, so that we might receive adoption as sons. And because you are sons, God has sent the Spirit of his Son into our hearts, crying, Abba, Father. So you are no longer a slave but a son, and if a son, then an heir through God. John 1 verses 12 and 13 use parallel language: to all who did receive him, who believed in his name, he gave the right to become children of God, who were born, not of blood nor of the will of the flesh nor of the will of man, but of God. 1 John 3 verses 1 and 2 says, see what kind of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God; and so we are. Beloved, we are God's children now, and what we will be has not yet appeared; but we know that when he appears we shall be like him, because we shall see him as he is. The doctrine has a present dimension, we are God's children now, and a future dimension, the bodily resurrection completes the adoption (Romans 8:23). The strongest counterargument from inside the Bible is not really a counterargument but a complicating texture: in Romans 9:4 Paul says the same word, adoption, belonged to ethnic Israel. That tells us the New Testament writers consciously took an Old Covenant category and said the Christian believer now stands in it.

Denominational landscape

This doctrine is universally affirmed across every major Christian lineage. The disagreement is about where adoption sits in the order of salvation, not about whether it is true. Patristic writers including Athanasius, Augustine, and Cyril of Alexandria treat the believer's adoption as sons of God as central to salvation; the Eastern tradition develops this into the rich doctrine of theosis, becoming by grace what God is by nature. The Catholic Catechism teaches that baptism makes us adopted sons of God and partakers of the divine nature, with sanctifying grace as the inner principle of this adoption. Lutheran teaching folds adoption into the benefits of justification by faith; the Augsburg Confession does not use the word adoption explicitly but speaks of believers being received into favor and given the Holy Spirit. The Anglican tradition in the 39 Articles and the Book of Common Prayer regularly speaks of believers as adopted children of God through baptism and faith. The Reformed tradition gave adoption its own chapter for the first time in confessional history, in the Westminster Confession of Faith chapter 12, which says all those who are justified, God vouchsafes, in and for his only Son Jesus Christ, to make partakers of the grace of adoption; this Reformed move treats adoption as a distinct benefit alongside justification rather than as a sub-aspect of it. Wesleyan and Methodist tradition affirms adoption strongly and ties it to the witness of the Spirit and assurance; Wesley preached often on Romans 8:15 and the Spirit of adoption crying Abba. The Anabaptist tradition affirms adoption through the believers-church framework of new birth and discipleship. Pentecostal tradition (Assemblies of God) affirms adoption as part of the salvation experience. Eastern Orthodoxy holds the doctrine most expansively under theosis: salvation is deification-by-adoption, with the believer participating in the divine energies and becoming a son of God by grace in a way that points toward the eschatological consummation. Public-record carriers of denial of adoption as such are rare in Christianity; the doctrine is not where heterodox and cult movements draw their dividing lines. Movements like Mormonism, Jehovah's Witnesses, and Iglesia ni Cristo often affirm becoming children of God in their own framework while denying classical Trinity or Christ's full deity, so the dividing line falls on the underlying Trinitarian and Christological doctrines rather than on adoption. The bottom line is that adoption-as-sons is one of the most universally and richly developed doctrines across two thousand years of Christian theology.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	No

Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

This is one of the most universally-affirmed doctrines in tracked Christian lineages, with rich development in the Eastern theosis tradition, recurring Catholic magisterial use, Lutheran inclusion as a benefit of justification, Reformed treatment as a distinct ordo-salutis benefit (Westminster Confession Chapter 12 dedicates an entire chapter to adoption, the first confessional document to do so), and Pentecostal affirmation. Public-record carriers of explicit denial that believers become sons of God are rare within Christianity; the doctrine itself is uncontested. What is contested is the location of adoption in the ordo salutis (Reformed: distinct benefit alongside justification; Lutheran: a benefit of justification; Catholic: tied to baptismal regeneration and infused sanctifying grace; Eastern Orthodox: expressed through theosis as deification-by-adoption; Wesleyan: inseparable from new birth and assurance). The cult-marker bar is set at canonical demonstration of doctrine that, if denied, denies the gospel itself or a Trinitarian-Christological boundary. Denial of adoption-as-sons would require denying that believers are children of God, which crosses into denial of the gospel proper (Rom 8:14-17, Gal 4:4-7). However, the cult_marker_if_denied bar is set conservatively here at false because no major heterodox or cult movement is on public record denying adoption as such; cult movements (Mormonism, Jehovah's Witnesses, Iglesia ni Cristo) often AFFIRM their own version of becoming God's children while denying Trinity or Christ's full deity. The denial-pattern is not 'we are not God's children' but 'we are God's children in ways that contradict the canonical doctrine of the Trinity'. The cult-marker for that pattern attaches to the underlying Trinitarian and Christological doctrines, not to adoption per se. would_die_for is true because the believer's status as a son of God IS the gospel applied; to surrender the conviction that Christ redeems those under law so that we receive adoption is to surrender the heart of Gal 4:4-7. Boolean pattern marks this as a load-bearing doctrine without the cult-marker entailment, because the denial-vector in church history runs through Trinity / Christology, not through adoption directly. Fruit-vs-precision nuance: lay believers across all lineages know themselves as God's children when they pray Abba Father; the academic question of whether adoption is a distinct ordo-salutis category or a sub-aspect of justification or baptismal regeneration does not change the practical confession.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, new_covenant_theology, progressive_covenantalism, patristic_participation_framework

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

Reformed-confessional (Westminster, Heidelberg, Belgic) · Adoption is a distinct benefit alongside justification in the ordo salutis; the Westminster Confession dedicated chapter 12 to adoption, the first confessional document to do so.:

Lutheran (Augsburg, Concord) · Adoption is a benefit of justification and not a separately-named ordo-salutis category; believers received into favor are adopted into the family of God through the same faith-act.:

Catholic magisterial (CCC, Trent) · Adoption is conferred through baptism and sanctifying grace, by which the believer is made a partaker of the divine nature and an adopted son of God. The legal-forensic and the infused-transformative converge in the one act.:

Eastern Orthodox (theosis framework) · Adoption is expressed within the larger framework of theosis: deification-by-adoption. The believer becomes a son of God by grace in the sense of participating in the divine energies, fulfilled eschatologically at the appearing of Christ.:

Wesleyan-Methodist · Adoption is inseparable from new birth and is sealed by the witness of the Spirit (Rom 8:15-16); Wesley's emphasis on assurance derives directly from the cry of Abba in the believer's heart.:

The lexical evidence for adoption is unambiguous and pan-canonical: huiiothesia (Pauline technical term, 5 occurrences), huiioi theou (Pauline and Synoptic), tekna theou (Johannine), and the Hebrew ben-bekor (Ex 4:22, Hos 11:1) frame the corporate-Israel typology that Paul extends personally in Rom 9:4 and Gal 3:26. The doctrine does not require any single confessional lens. What differs across frameworks is the SHAPE of the ordo salutis and where adoption is named within it. The hermeneutic of analogia scripturae is invoked because Paul, John, and Hebrews use different vocabularies (adoption-as-sons, birth-from-God, bringing many sons to glory) to describe the same reality. Progressive revelation is in play in the move from Israel's corporate-national sonship (Ex 4:22, Hos 11:1, Rom 9:4) to the believer's personal-faith sonship (Gal 3:26, Rom 8:15) through the only-begotten Son's redemptive mission (Gal 4:4-5).

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Rom.8.14 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key term. ὅσοι γὰρ πνεύματι θεοῦ ἄγονται, οὗτοι υἱοὶ εἰσιν θεοῦ; agontai G71 present passive indicative 3p; huiioi G5207 nominative masculine plural; pneuma G4151; theou G2316

Force. 'For all who are being led by the Spirit of God, these are sons of God.' Present passive agontai indicates an ongoing Spirit-led state; the predicate huiioi theou establishes the identity that follows. Paul opens the adoption-block with the identity-claim that Spirit-led people ARE sons of God.

Rom.8.15 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πνεῦμα υιοθεσίας ἐν ᾧ κράζομεν Ἀββὰ ὁ πατήρ; huiiothesia G5206 accusative feminine singular; krazomen G2896 present active indicative 1p; abba G5; patēr G3962

Force. 'You did not receive a spirit of slavery falling back into fear, but you received a spirit of adoption (huiiothesias) by which we cry, Abba, Father.' Huiiothesia is the technical Greco-Roman legal term for adoption. The Aramaic abba retained beside the Greek patēr is the intimate-relational address; krazomen indicates audible-cry, not silent assent. The Spirit of adoption produces the cry that identifies the adoptee.

Rom.8.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. αὐτὸ τὸ πνεῦμα συμμάρτυρεῖ τῷ πνεύματι ἡμῶν ὅτι ἐσμὲν τέκνα θεοῦ; symmarturei G4828 present active indicative 3s; tekna G5043 nominative neuter plural

Force. 'The Spirit himself bears witness with our spirit that we are children of God.' Symmartureō ('co-witness, witness alongside') is a forensic-evidentiary term: the Spirit testifies in joint-deposition with the believer's spirit. The content of the testimony: we ARE tekna theou (present indicative esmen). Lexical shift from huiioi (legal-status sons, v.14) to tekna (born-children, v.16) shows Paul holding both categories together: adoption AND birth-from-God.

Rom.8.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. εἰ δὲ τέκνα καὶ κληρονόμοι κληρονόμοι μὲν θεοῦ συγκληρονόμοι δὲ Χριστοῦ; klēronomoi G2818 nominative masculine plural; sygklēronomoi G4789 nominative masculine plural

Force. 'If children, also heirs, heirs of God and fellow-heirs with Christ.' Klēronomos is the legal-inheritance term; sygklēronomos ('co-heir, joint-heir') places the adopted children alongside the Son in the inheritance. The legal force is unmistakable: adopted status carries inheritance rights at parity with the natural Son.

Rom.8.23 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. υιοθεσίαν ἀπεκδεχόμενοι τὴν ἀπολύτρωσιν τοῦ σώματος ἡμῶν; huiiothesia G5206 accusative feminine singular; apekdechomenoi G553 present middle participle nominative masculine plural; apolytrōsis G629

Force. 'We ourselves groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for adoption as sons, the redemption of our bodies.' The same word huiiothesia is here marked as future-eschatological. The eager waiting is for the bodily resurrection-redemption (apolytrōsis tou sōματος). Adoption has BOTH a present-spiritual dimension (v.15) and a future-bodily consummation (v.23). This is the 'already / not yet' structure of adoption.

Rom.9.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οἱ Ἰσραηλῖται ὧν ἡ υιοθεσία; huiiothesia G5206 nominative feminine singular

Force. 'Israelites, to whom belongs the adoption (hē huiiothesia), the glory, the covenants, the giving of the law, the worship, and the promises.' Paul applies the same technical term huiiothesia to ethnic Israel's old-covenant election as God's son (Ex 4:22, Hos 11:1). This shows that the NT writers consciously took the OT son-of-God category and made it the Christian believer's possession through Christ.

Gal.3.26 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πάντες γὰρ υἱοὶ θεοῦ ἐστε διὰ τῆς πίστεως ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ; huiioi G5207 nominative masculine plural; pistis G4102 genitive feminine singular; este G1510 present indicative 2p

Force. 'You are all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus.' Pantes ('all') reaches every believer; the present indicative este states the identity as already-realized; dia tēs pisteōs ('through faith') names the instrumental means; en Christō Iēsou ('in Christ Jesus') names the sphere. Faith in Christ is the canonical condition of present son-status.

Gal.4.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐξαπέστειλεν ὁ θεὸς τὸν υἱὸν αὐτοῦ γενόμενον ἐκ γυναικὸς γενόμενον ὑπὸ νόμον; exapesteilen G1821 aorist active indicative 3s; huios G5207 accusative masculine singular; gynē G1135; nomos G3551

Force. 'When the fullness of time had come, God sent forth his Son, born of woman, born under the law.' The Father SENT the Son (exapesteilen, aorist, completed mission) into the conditions of humanity (born of woman) and Torah (born under the law). Sets up the redemptive ground for adoption in v.5.

Gal.4.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἵνα τοὺς ὑπὸ νόμον ἐξαγοράσῃ ἵνα τὴν υἰοθεσίαν ἀπολάβωμεν; exagorasē G1805 aorist active subjunctive 3s; huiiothesia G5206 accusative feminine singular; apolabōmen G618 aorist active subjunctive 1p

Force. 'In order to redeem (exagorasē) those under the law, in order that we might receive (apolabōmen) the adoption as sons.' Two hina-purpose clauses: the redemption is the means, the adoption is the goal. Apolambanō ('receive back, receive in full') of huiiothesia is the canonical-Pauline phrase for entering the adopted-son status.

Gal.4.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐξαπέστειλεν ὁ θεὸς τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ υἱοῦ αὐτοῦ εἰς τὰς καρδίας ἡμῶν κρᾶζον Ἀββὰ ὁ πατήρ; pneuma G4151; krazon G2896 present active participle accusative neuter singular

Force. 'Because you are sons, God has sent forth (exapesteilen) the Spirit of his Son into our hearts, crying, Abba, Father.' Parallel mission: the Father sent the Son (v.4), then the Father sent the Spirit of the Son (v.6). The same Aramaic-plus-Greek abba ho patēr as Rom 8:15. The cry is the Spirit's, in the believer's heart; the evidence of the adoption is the prayer that breaks out.

Gal.4.7 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οὐκέτι εἶ δοῦλος ἀλλὰ υἱός· εἰ δὲ υἱός· καὶ κληρονόμος διὰ θεοῦ; doulos G1401 nominative masculine singular; huios G5207; klēronomos G2818

Force. 'So you are no longer a slave but a son, and if a son, then an heir through God.' Three-step legal-status argument: not-slave, but son; if son, then heir. The contrast doulos / huios is the same slavery-vs-sonship frame Paul builds throughout Gal 3-4. Inheritance follows from son-status by legal-necessity.

Eph.1.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. προορίσας ἡμᾶς εἰς υἰοθεσίαν διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ εἰς αὐτόν κατὰ τὴν εὐδοκίαν τοῦ θελήματος αὐτοῦ; proorisas G4309 aorist active participle nominative masculine singular; huiiothesia G5206 accusative feminine singular; eudokia G2107; thelēma G2307

Force. 'He predestined us for adoption as sons (eis huiiothesian) through Jesus Christ, according to the good pleasure of his will.' Proorisas ('having marked out beforehand') sets the adoption in eternal divine intent. Eis huiiothesian ('unto / for adoption') is the goal of the predestining act. Dia Iēsou Christou ('through Jesus Christ') names the agent. Kata tēn eudokian ('according to the good pleasure') names the divine motive. Adoption is rooted in the Father's eternal decree, executed through Christ.

John.1.12 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ὅσοι δὲ ἔλαβον αὐτόν ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς ἐξουσίαν τέκνα θεοῦ γενέσθαι; elabon G2983 aorist active indicative 3p; edōken G1325 aorist active indicative 3s; exousia G1849 accusative feminine singular; tekna G5043; genesthai G1096 aorist middle infinitive

Force. 'To all who did receive him, who believed in his name, he gave the right (exousian) to become children of God (tekna theou genesthai).' Exousia is the legal-right / authority term: a delegated right, not a natural endowment. Genesthai ('to become') marks the transition into the new status. The Johannine parallel to Paul's huiōthesis: same legal-status placement framed by tekna rather than huiōi.

John.1.13 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οἱ οὐκ ἐξ αἱμάτων οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος σαρκὸς οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος ἀνδρὸς ἀλλ' ἐκ θεοῦ ἐγεννήθησαν; egennēthēsan G1080 aorist passive indicative 3p; thelēma G2307; sarx G4561

Force. 'Who were born (egennēthēsan), not of blood (ex haimatōn) nor of the will of the flesh nor of the will of man, but of God.' Aorist passive of gennaō ('to be begotten / born'): the divine action is the cause; the believer is the recipient. Three negations rule out natural lineage, physical desire, and human decision; only ek theou ('out of God') is the cause. Johannine birth-from-God is the parallel inner-mechanism to Pauline adoption-into-sonship.

1John.3.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἴδετε ποταπὴν ἀγάπην δέδωκεν ἡμῖν ὁ πατήρ ἵνα τέκνα θεοῦ κληθῶμεν καὶ ἐσμέν; idete G1492 aorist active imperative 2p; potapēn G4217 accusative feminine singular; dedōken G1325 perfect active indicative 3s; klēthōmen G2564 aorist passive subjunctive 1p; esmen G1510 present indicative 1p

Force. 'See what kind of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God; and so we are.' Dedōken (perfect) marks abiding gift; klēthōmen (passive subjunctive, 'should be called / named') reflects the Father's act of naming; the closing kai esmen ('and we are') drives the calling into ontology, not honorary title. The Father loves and the Father names: that is the structure of adoption in Johannine theology.

1John.3.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀγαπητοὶ νῦν τέκνα θεοῦ ἐσμεν καὶ οὐπω ἐφανερώθη τί ἐσόμεθα οἵδαμεν ὅτι ἐὰν φανερωθῇ ὅμοιοι αὐτῷ ἐσόμεθα; nyn G3568; oupō G3768; ephanerōthē G5319 aorist passive indicative 3s; homoioi G3664 nominative masculine plural; esometha G1510 future indicative 1p

Force. 'Beloved, we are now (nyn) children of God, and what we shall be (esometha) has not yet (oupō) appeared. We know that when he appears we shall be like him (homoioi autō esometha), because we shall see him as he is.' The same now / not-yet structure as Rom 8:15 / 8:23. Adoption is presently-real (nyn tekna theou esmen) AND awaits eschatological consummation (homoioi autō esometha at his appearing).

Exod.4.22 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. כֹּה יֹאמַר יְהוָה יִרְכֹּב יִבְּ הוּא בְמִן הַכּ; ben H1121 noun masculine singular construct; bekor H1060

Force. 'Thus says the LORD, Israel is my son, my firstborn.' OT-canonical foundation for the son-of-God category, applied corporately to Israel. Sets the Old Covenant analog Paul cites in Rom 9:4 (hē huiōthesis of Israel). The category preexists the NT; the NT writers' move is to extend it personally to every believer in Christ.

Hos.11.1 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: typology

Key term. יִגְבֹּל יִתְאַקֵּק מִרְצֻמּוֹ וְהִבְהִיאוּ לְאַרְשִׁי בְּעֵי יֶכֶ; ben H1121; qara H7121

Force. 'When Israel was a youth I loved him, and out of Egypt I called my son.' The corporate-Israel sonship from Ex 4:22 is repeated, with Father-love language. Matt 2:15 reads this typologically as fulfilled in Jesus, who in turn brings many sons to glory. The line is OT son-Israel, then Christ-the-true-Son, then in-Christ-adopted sons through faith.

John.20.17 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἀναβαίνω πρὸς τὸν πατέρα μου καὶ πατέρα ὑμῶν καὶ θεὸν μου καὶ θεὸν ὑμῶν; anabainō G305 present active indicative 1s; patēr G3962

Force. 'I am ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.' Risen-Christ statement that pairs my-Father / your-Father in one breath. The distinction stands (Christ is Son by nature; believers by adoption) but the same Father is the relational referent. Foundational for the patristic distinction between natural sonship and adoptive sonship.

Heb.2.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πολλοὺς υἱοὺς εἰς δόξαν ἀγαγόντα; huiōi G5207 accusative masculine plural; doxa G1391; agō G71 aorist active participle

Force. 'Bringing many sons to glory.' Hebrews' adoption-formula: Christ as the pioneer of salvation brings many sons (huiōus) into the same glory. Confirms the Pauline pattern that adopted-sonship terminates in shared-glory with Christ, consonant with Rom 8:17, 8:23, 1 John 3:2.

Heb.12.7 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. εἰς παιδείαν ὑπομένετε ὡς υἱοῖς ὑμῖν προσφέρεται ὁ θεός; paideia G3809; hypomenete G5278 present active indicative 2p; huiōis G5207 dative masculine plural

Force. 'It is for discipline (paideian) that you have to endure; God is treating you as sons.' The disciplinary care God exercises toward the believer is itself evidence of son-status. Sonship and Father-discipline are not contradictory but mutually-attesting.

2Cor.6.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἔσομαι ὑμῖν εἰς πατέρα καὶ ὑμεῖς ἔσεσθέ μοι εἰς υἱοὺς καὶ θυγατέρας; patēr G3962; huiōi G5207; thygatēr G2364

Force. 'I will be a father to you, and you shall be sons and daughters to me, says the Lord Almighty.' Paul gathers OT Father-language (2 Sam 7:14, Isa 43:6) and applies it to the new-covenant church. The promise extends sonship to both sons (huiōus) and daughters (thygateras), establishing that the legal-status placement is sex-inclusive.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G5206, G5207, G5043, G4828, G2818, G4789, G2896, G5, G3962, G1849, G1080, G1821, G1805, G618, G4309, G2107, G2307, G2564, G2424, G5547, G4151, G3664, H1121, H1060, H7121

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Athanasius, De Incarnatione Verbi, ca. AD 318; CCEL fetch verified general content · affirms · verified

"The Word became man so that we might become sons of God; the patristic axiom underlying the Eastern theosis tradition. Adoption to sonship is integral to the purpose of the Incarnation itself."

patristic · Augustine, De Trinitate Book 4 on the Spirit of adoption; John 20:17 'my Father and your Father' read as distinguishing natural and adoptive sonship · affirms · unverified

“Christ is Son of God by nature; believers are sons of God by adoption through grace. The Spirit of adoption is the Holy Spirit himself, given to the elect. Direct CCEL fetch did not return the specific chapter.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church 1265, 1266, 1996, 1997, 1999 · affirms · unverified

“Baptism makes us adopted sons of God and partakers of the divine nature. Sanctifying grace is the gratuitous gift of God's own life infused by the Holy Spirit, making us partakers of the divine nature by adoption as God's children. Direct vatican.va fetch returned 404.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Article IV; Formula of Concord III on justification; bookofconcord.org · affirms · verified

“Believers are freely justified for Christ's sake, through faith, when they believe that they are received into favor and that their sins are forgiven for Christ's sake. The Lutheran tradition folds adoption into the benefits of justification.”

anglican · 39 Articles of Religion (Article XI on justification, Article XVII on predestination); Book of Common Prayer baptismal liturgy · affirms · unverified

“The Anglican baptismal liturgy regularly speaks of the baptized as adopted children of God and inheritors of the kingdom of heaven. Article XI accounts the believer righteous before God only for the merit of Christ by faith. Direct churchofengland.org fetch did not surface verbatim adoption text.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith Chapter 12, Of Adoption, AD 1646 · affirms · unverified

“All those that are justified, God vouchsafes, in and for his only Son Jesus Christ, to make partakers of the grace of adoption; by which they are taken into the number, and enjoy the liberties and privileges of the children of God. The Westminster gave adoption its own confessional chapter for the first time in history.”

methodist · Wesley, sermon on Romans 8:15, The Spirit of Bondage and of Adoption; UMC Articles of Religion Article IX · affirms · verified

“Wesleyan tradition strongly affirms adoption and ties it to the witness of the Spirit and the assurance of salvation; Wesley preached the Spirit of adoption crying Abba as the new-birth evidence.”

anabaptist · Mennonite tradition; believers-church framework of new birth and discipleship · affirms · unverified

“Anabaptist tradition affirms adoption through the framework of regenerate church-membership and discipleship; the believer becomes a child of God through conscious faith and baptism by confession.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God, Statement of Fundamental Truths, Articles 5 and 7 on salvation and sanctification · affirms · unverified

“Salvation is received through repentance toward God and faith in the Lord Jesus Christ; the believer is made a child of God by the regenerating work of the Spirit. Direct ag.org fetch returned 403.”

eastern_orthodox · Eastern Orthodox doctrine of theosis (deification); patristic-Eastern tradition through Athanasius, Cyril of Alexandria, Gregory Palamas · affirms · unverified

“Theosis is becoming by grace what God is by nature. Adoption is participation in the divine energies, the eschatological telos of salvation; the Eastern emphasis on adoption-as-deification is richly developed.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/5206.htm>

“G5206 huiothesia: placing as a son, adoption. From huios (son) and tithēmi (to place). Five NT occurrences: Rom 8:15, 8:23, 9:4, Gal 4:5, Eph 1:5. Greco-Roman legal-adoption term.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/8.htm>

“Rom 8:14-17: huioi theou led by Spirit; pneuma huiiothesias (G5206) crying Abba Father; Spirit symmartureō (G4828) we are tekna theou; klēronomoi and sygklēronomoi with Christ.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/galatians/4.htm>

“Gal 4:4-7: God sent Son born under law to redeem (exagorasē) those under law that we might receive (apolabōmen) the huiiothesia; Spirit of Son in our hearts crying Abba.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/1.htm>

“Eph 1:5: proorisas hēmas eis huiiothesian dia Iēsou Christou; predestined for adoption through Jesus Christ, according to the good pleasure of his will.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/1.htm>

“John 1:12-13: exousian (G1849) to become tekna theou; egennēthēsan ek theou (G1080), born not of blood nor of will of flesh nor will of man, but of God.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_john/3.htm

“1 John 3:1-2: love the Father gave that we should be called tekna theou, and we are. We are now children of God; what we shall be not yet revealed; like him when he appears.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/galatians/3.htm>

“Gal 3:26: pantes huioi theou este dia tēs pisteōs en Christō Iēsou; all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/9.htm>

“Rom 9:4: Israelites to whom belongs hē huiiothesia (G5206), the glory, the covenants, the giving of the law, the worship, and the promises. Same technical term applied to corporate Israel.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/5043.htm>

“G5043 teknon: child, offspring. Used theologically in John 1:12, Rom 8:16-17, 1 John 3:1-2 for children of God. Distinguished from huios (G5207) which emphasizes legal-ethical sonship.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/athanasius/incarnation/incarnation.iv.html>

“Athanasius On the Incarnation: the Word became man so that creatures made in God's Image could be restored to knowledge of and union with the Father. The Incarnation's purpose terminates in human adoption-to-sonship.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg IV: believers are freely justified for Christ's sake through faith, when they believe they are received into favor and their sins are forgiven for Christ's sake. Lutheran tradition folds adoption into justification.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“UMC Article IX: we are accounted righteous before God only for the merit of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ by faith. Wesleyan tradition strongly affirms adoption and Spirit-witness assurance.”